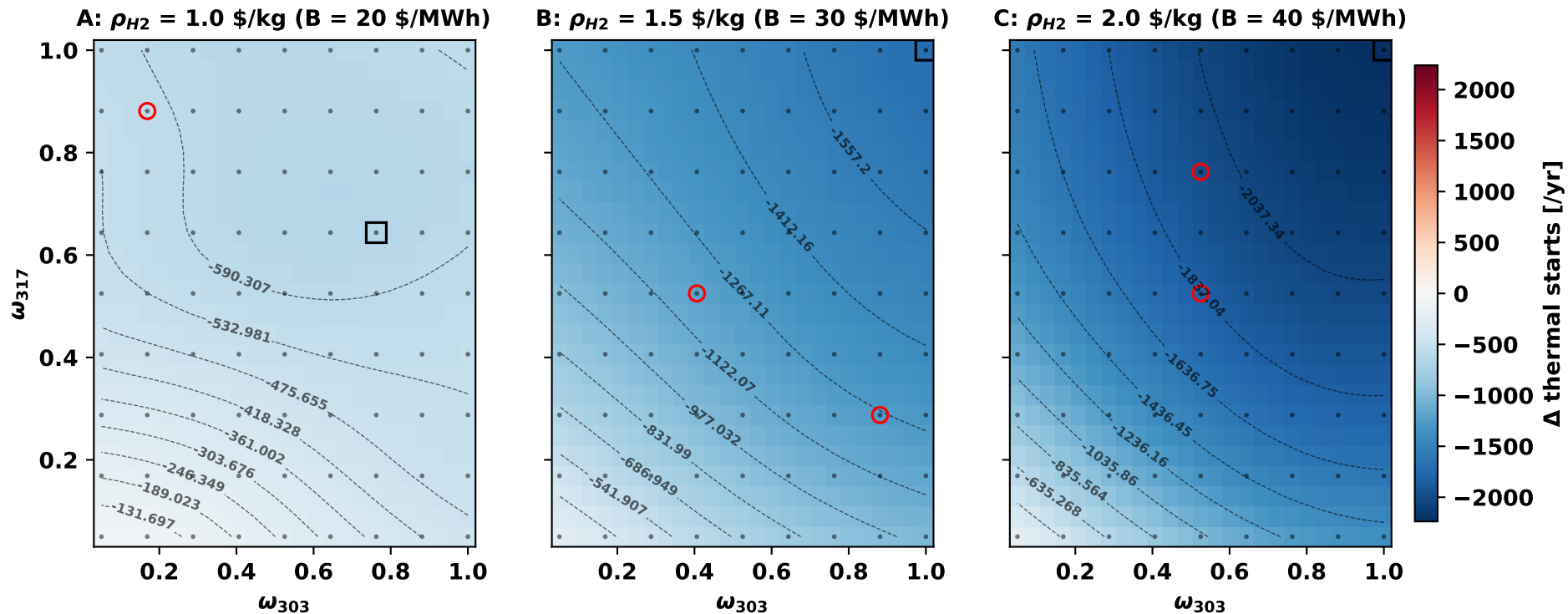


Δ thermal starts [/yr] on the 303x317 pair grid (blue = improvement vs base)



GP posterior mean (Matern-2.5 ARD, per-surface standardization, fitted white noise) on 25x25; dots = 81 direct runs; open red circles = $|\text{observed} - \text{posterior mean}| > 2 \times \text{LOOCV RMSE}$. open square: argmin cell; no noise floor established — location indicative only. Contour spacing $\geq$ LOOCV RMSE (working floor).
 LOOCV (81-fold, per-fold standardization): A: $Q^2=0.86$, RMSE=55.16, flagged 1/81, argmin marked; B: $Q^2=0.97$, RMSE=55.60, flagged 2/81, argmin marked; C: $Q^2=0.99$, RMSE=40.60, flagged 2/81, argmin marked